



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*ucchrñkhalāpyākṛtikā sthitirdhīrasya rājate |
na tu saṁsprhacittasya śāntirmūḍhasya kṛtrimā | |18|52| |*

— Aṣṭāvakragītā, Prakaraṇa 18 (Chapter 18), Verse 52

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The untamed, spontaneous state of a wise person shines with unparalleled beauty, while the contrived peace of a deluded mind, still clinging to desires, remains a hollow facade. Ashtavakra is highlighting the profound difference between authentic liberation and superficial tranquility. He suggests that true inner peace isn't about suppressing your nature or forcing yourself into a mold, but about transcending the ego's grip on desires and aversions.

Think of a river: when unburdened by dams and diversions, it flows freely, carving its own path with grace and power. Similarly, a liberated mind, free from the constraints of ego and attachment, expresses itself naturally and spontaneously. This might appear "untamed" or "unconventional" to those still caught in the web of societal expectations and conditioning. But this very freedom is the hallmark of true wisdom.

In contrast, the "contrived peace" refers to the artificial calmness sought by those who haven't truly addressed their inner turmoil. They might engage in practices like meditation or yoga, but their underlying motivations are often rooted in a desire to escape discomfort or gain something – peace, happiness, enlightenment. This approach is akin to painting over rust; the underlying problem remains, and the peace is only temporary.

How does this relate to your life? Are you striving for a genuine sense of freedom and acceptance, or are you trying to force yourself into a state of calmness that doesn't feel authentic? Are you clinging to desires and expectations, even as you seek inner peace? The Aṣṭāvakragītā encourages you to embrace your true nature, to let go of the need to control and manipulate your experiences, and to trust in the inherent wisdom of your being. It challenges you to examine the motivations behind your spiritual practices and to ensure that they are aligned with a genuine desire for liberation, rather than a mere attempt to escape the discomfort of the present moment. Ultimately, true peace arises not from suppressing your nature, but from understanding and transcending it.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you willing to let go of your carefully constructed image of peace and embrace the untamed beauty of your authentic self? Can you trust that true wisdom lies not in control, but in effortless being?